

Getting Ripped Is the Highest ROI a Man Can Get

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Sep 02, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FckBANuFvKA> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter argues that getting lean is the single highest-return investment a man can make — boosting attractiveness, career prospects, confidence, and delayed-gratification skills — then delivers a precise fat-loss protocol to get there.

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Why Getting Ripped Is the Highest ROI 0:00

- Carter's core claim: getting shredded is the **single best investment a man can make in himself**
 - Most people calculate the return incorrectly — they only think about abs, but the benefits extend far beyond aesthetics
 - Benefits include: looking better in and out of clothes, improved health, improved perception by others, more confidence, more discipline, better career outcomes
- Your body goes with you everywhere — every business meeting, first date, vacation, and photo
 - "Your body is the vehicle in which you experience your entire life. When you improve the vehicle, you potentially improve thousands of experiences that can happen after that."
 - Buying an expensive watch or car and putting it on a neglected body is "gift wrapping on doo-doo" — the packaging doesn't fix what's underneath
- The ROI is not just physical; it spills into every domain of life simultaneously

Getting Lean Is Cheaper Than You Think 1:08

- Common objections — "I don't have money" or "I don't have time" — are actually solved BY getting lean, not blocked by it
 - Getting lean requires eating less → you spend less money on food
 - Eating less → frees up time previously spent eating, cooking, or going out
- "People say abs are made in the kitchen. No, abs are made by keeping your goofy ass out the kitchen."
- Time and money saved can be redirected to: making more money, spending more time with family and kids
- Compared to designer clothes, cars, watches, or cosmetic procedures, getting lean costs almost nothing

😍 **Attractiveness: The Most Visible Benefit 3:09**

- Getting lean is the **#1 attractiveness upgrade** available to a man without surgery
 - Height and facial bone structure cannot be changed; body composition can
 - Research cited: when women were asked to manipulate images of male bodies to create the most attractive version, **every woman preferred a combination of muscularity and low body fat**
- Fat affects the face dramatically — Carter estimates **90% of "looks-maxing" is simply getting lean**
 - Losing body fat changes jawline visibility, facial structure perception, and overall face shape
 - Research shows people can accurately estimate body composition just from looking at someone's face
- Getting leaner makes you look bigger, not smaller
 - Waist-to-shoulder ratio is accentuated → stronger V-taper
 - Definition, cuts, and vein visibility make muscles appear larger even at lower body weight
 - Carter's personal example: people thought he got bigger when he cut from 205–215 lbs down to **195 lbs**
 - Hollywood reference points (all muscular but lean, not mass-monster sized):

Actor	Movie	Height	Approximate Weight
Michael B. Jordan	Creed	~6'0"	~175 lbs
Brad Pitt	Fight Club	Under 6'0"	~170 lbs
Chris Hemsworth (implied)	First Thor	~6'2"	Under 200 lbs

- "Getting lean will make you look bigger. It accentuates your muscles more. A lot of you are so concerned with getting big — you need to just get ripped."

👛 **The Beauty Premium: Lean Bodies Make More Money 6:59**

- Researchers call it the **"beauty premium"** — physical attractiveness has a measurable, documented effect on professional outcomes
 - This is not a claim that losing weight makes you rich overnight; it is a claim backed by multiple studies
- Study 1 — Meta-analysis on attractiveness and job-related outcomes:
 - Attractive people were received more favorably in job evaluations

- Attractive people were promoted more frequently
- Study 2 — Longitudinal study tracking men over decades:
 - Researchers rated men's facial attractiveness when young, then tracked earnings over time
 - More attractive men had **significantly higher earnings** that persisted into their 30s, 40s, and 50s
- Study 3 — Early-career study:
 - More attractive employees received greater career exposure, more visibility, and higher salaries throughout their careers
- Practical implication: "You wouldn't hire a fat personal trainer. That's like a homeless success coach."
- Humans make snap judgments before a single word is spoken — appearance is part of your **personal brand**
 - A muscular, lean physique signals to observers: consistency, energy, health, self-control, discipline, focus
 - These assumptions aren't always accurate, but they consistently influence first impressions and outcomes

Your Physique as a Multiplier for Everything Else 10:37

- A lean physique functions as a **multiplier** — it amplifies everything else you already have
 - The watch looks better on a lean body
 - The suit looks better
 - The vacation photos look better
 - Even a cheap fitted white t-shirt and jeans looks incredible on a lean, muscular frame
- Carter's direct comparison: a lean guy in an Amazon shirt looks better than an out-of-shape guy in a \$5,000 designer outfit
 - "I see fat boys in Miami think they doing something. They squeeze themselves into the Lambo and still get laughed at."
- Thought experiment: two men, identical in age, income, intelligence, career, and charisma — one visibly fit, one not
 - The fit man appears to have more control over his life
 - He's more likely to be chosen as a leader or team member
- Key insight: you don't have to choose between making money and getting in shape — **the combination is more powerful than either alone**

Confidence and Discipline: The Hidden ROI 14:03

- Carter's observation: "100% of people who ask me how to get more confidence are not shredded. Not once has someone who was shredded asked me that."
- Getting shredded doesn't create confidence directly — it creates confidence as a **side effect of keeping promises to yourself**

- Every day of training kept = a kept promise
- Every day of hitting calorie targets = a kept promise
- Every day of getting steps in = a kept promise
- Hundreds of repetitions of this build a mental evidence base: "When I tell myself I'm going to do something, I do it."
- "Confidence comes from evidence. You have to give yourself a reason to be confident."
 - This is not affirmations or pretending — it is proof accumulated through consistent action
- Daily promises required to get lean:
 - Follow the right diet
 - Follow the right workout plan
 - Get cardio (steps)
 - Get enough sleep
 - Drink enough water



Delayed Gratification: The Real Skill You're Building 15:13

- Carter's biggest claim: "The six-pack is not even the most valuable thing you're going to build."
- Getting lean requires repeatedly choosing long-term benefit over short-term pleasure
 - Things that feel good now but hurt long-term: ice cream, getting high, playing video games, chasing women
 - Things that are good long-term but feel hard now: drinking a gallon of water daily, consistent sleep schedule, discipline
- Delayed gratification is a **sign of maturity** — children literally cannot do it (they want what they want immediately and cry until they get it)
 - The more mature you become, the more capable you are of delaying gratification — and it is a learnable skill
- Every meaningful life outcome requires this same skill:
 - Building a business → delayed gratification
 - Investing → delayed gratification
 - Learning a new skill → delayed gratification
 - Building a great relationship → delayed gratification
 - Creating content for years → delayed gratification

"While you're building your body, you're simultaneously practicing the psychological skill that helps you build everything else in your life. The six-pack isn't the most valuable thing to build — the person capable of having a six-pack is."



The Exact Fat-Loss Prescription 17:34

- Carter's stated goal: get as lean as possible, as quickly as possible

Calories: - Formula: **current body weight in pounds × 10 = daily calorie target** - Example: 200 lb person → 2,000 calories per day - This is based on current body weight, not goal body weight

Protein: - Formula: **1 gram of protein per pound of current body weight** - Example: 200 lb person → 200g protein per day - Carter personally averages 250–300g protein per day - Why high protein works — the **thermic effect of food** by macronutrient:

Macronutrient	Calories Burned During Digestion
Fat	~3% of calories consumed
Carbohydrates	10–15% of calories consumed
Protein	20–30% of calories consumed

- Practical result: if you eat 100 calories of protein, your body only absorbs 70–80 of them
 - Protein has 2–3× the thermogenic effect of any other macronutrient
 - Also helps preserve muscle mass while in a calorie deficit
 - "If you know it has the highest thermogenic effect of any food, why wouldn't you capitalize on that?"

Daily Steps: - Target: **20,000 steps per day** - Carter calls this "a chico" (a cheat code) — everyone who does it gets shredded - Average person burns an **extra 800–1,000 calories per day** at this step count - Sample daily schedule to hit 20,000 steps: - Morning: 30-minute walk → ~3,000 steps - After lunch: 30-minute walk → ~3,000 steps - After work: 1-hour walk (can include kids, dog, social) → ~6,000 steps - During work: walk 10 minutes every hour → remaining steps accumulated throughout the day - Optional tool: walking pad at home for working hours - If your job won't let you move: "Get a different career. We're free now."

Workouts: - Frequency: **full body workouts 3–4 times per week** - Volume per session: - Pick 1–2 exercises per body part - Do 2–3 sets per exercise - Rest no more than 60–90 seconds between sets - Total session duration: **45–60 minutes** (not 3 hours — rest periods are timed) - Speed hack: **superset opposing muscle groups** - Biceps immediately followed by triceps - Chest immediately followed by back - Then rest 90 seconds before the next superset - "If you do that, it's going to be almost impossible for you to fail."

The Full Protocol at a Glance:

Variable	Target
Daily Calories	Bodyweight (lbs) × 10
Daily Protein	1g per lb of bodyweight
Daily Steps	20,000
Workouts	Full body, 3–4×/week
Sets per exercise	2–3
Rest between sets	60–90 seconds
Session length	45–60 minutes